

Accounting & Financial Analysis Project

Introduction and background

There have been a lot of technological advances in the world today. Technology has reshaped the way we live, study, work, communicate, and do business, among other things. Commerce, industry and education have not been left behind in this digital revolution. As you prepare to obtain your qualification, you need to take advantage of these advances to ensure that you develop technical skills, enabling competencies, and Professional Values, Attitudes and Acumens (PVAAs). This will make you equipped to be an agile and resilient professional.

This individual assignment does not cover all the PVAAs, but covers most of them, including the following:

PVAA	How the individual assignment will be assessed
Business Ethics	The assignment will test your ethical reasoning. You must behave ethically, considering ethical issues such as the accuracy, integrity and responsible use of information and GenAI outputs.
Business Acumen	The assignment will look at different business types and your ability to understand the selected company's financial information.
Critical and integrated thinking	A major part of the assignment is critiquing information so that you can reach conclusions after a critical and integrated thought process.
Digital acumen	At the heart of the assignment are digital skills. The assignment is based on Microsoft Office software such as Word, Excel and PowerPoint, PDF, generative AI tools (GenAI), and coding applications
Decision-making	You will make decisions from the onset of the assignment and throughout the entire document, including decisions about the company, tools, analytical approach and presentation of findings.
Problem solving (minimum)	Problems inform the assignment, hence problem-solving will be required to address the assignment questions and complete the required outputs.
Lifelong learning, Adaptive digital mindset and agility	The assignment deliberately takes you out of your comfort zone. It exposes you to unfamiliar terrain and enables you to learn new skills such as basic coding and deductive reasoning. The soft skills learnt when using software will remain with you.
Relational and communication Acumen	Although this is an individual assignment, clear written and visual communication is essential. You must communicate your analysis, reasoning, findings and conclusions effectively in the required documents and presentation.

Company selection and source financial statements

Select any JSE-listed company that has published financial statements available in the public domain. Download the company's financial statements and use them as the source material for the individual project.

INSTRUCTIONS (please read the instructions carefully and thoroughly before commencing with the tasks)

1. Select any JSE-listed company that has published financial statements available in the public domain. Once the company has been selected, download its Integrated Reports (Annual Financial Statements, 2021 to 2025 or 2020 to 2024). You will need these documents to complete the rest of the assignment.
2. Complete and submit the required individual outputs. These consist of: the MS Word document containing the GenAI prompts; the MS Excel Statement of Profit or Loss; the MS Word document containing the LaTeX code; the LaTeX-generated PDF report; the PowerPoint presentation or LaTeX beamer presentation; the individual work/process evidence where required; and the AI-generated video that summarises the entire assignment. All submitted work must represent your own individual contribution.
3. As this is an individual project, all marks are based on your own work. You are responsible for completing each required component, checking the accuracy of your calculations and analysis, and ensuring that your final submission is complete and ethically produced.
4. The assignment introduces you to basic coding. The software we will use is based on LaTeX, an open-source and freely available software. There are several LaTeX applications on the internet. To help you move faster, two easy-to-install applications are MiKTeX and Texmaker. You need to install both software applications on your Microsoft Windows device. You can download the files from the following links:
 - <https://miktex.org/download>
 - <https://www.latex-project.org/>
 - <https://www.xm1math.net/texmaker/download.html>
5. You are expected to develop a lot of PVAAAs during this assignment. Please be creative and think out of the box. YouTube and other learning resources can greatly help you understand the use of LaTeX and other tasks. Go out there and research what will work well for you. Above all, take ownership of your learning and document your individual process.

REQUIRED

- a) Prepare an individual plan for tackling the assignment. Organise your own responsibilities, decide which tools you will use, identify the information and

financial statements required, and plan how you will execute and document the project. Where a planning record or process evidence is required, it must reflect your own work and decision-making.

- b)** Using Microsoft Excel, redraft the Statement of Profit or Loss of your chosen company for the most recent (current) financial year available, considering the new requirements in terms of IFRS 18: Presentation and Disclosure in Financial Statements. The Excel spreadsheets must have formulas that show the computation of the income and expenses. The other comprehensive income and notes to the financial statements are NOT required.
- c)** Using MS Word, prepare a prompt of questions that will be fed into a GenAI tool. These questions must be structured to enable the tool to help you analyse the profitability, liquidity and debt-equity of the company for the last five years (including the current reporting date). The ratios to be generated must include net profit margin, return on assets (ROA), return on investment (ROI), current ratio, quick ratio and gearing ratio.
- d)** Having developed your prompts, feed them into your desired GenAI tool (ChatGPT, Gemini, Grok, Claude, DeepSeek, etc) and generate the analysis on the profitability and liquidity of your company for five years as required. Once the analysis is ready, request the AI tool to generate a LaTeX code for you, which you will use to prepare a LaTeX PDF report of your analysis. Copy this code into a separate Word document, as this code will be evaluated and serves as evidence of the work done.
- e)** Prepare a LaTeX PDF report of your analysis using the LaTeX software made available to you. The report must highlight the required ratios, as well as a general description of what the report is all about.
- f)** Prepare a PowerPoint, LaTeX beamer presentation or any presentation software such as Prezi, Canva, Google Slides, etc. that summarises your report. It must have charts explaining the trends in the required ratios for the five years. The presentation must be visually engaging, yet easy to understand.
- g)** Summarise your entire work by preparing a short video using any AI tools such as NotebookLM, Canva, HeyGen, etc. The video summary must be between 5 and 10 minutes long and capture the steps taken from planning through to the presentation preparation.